MERCY'S ANATOMY

Document MA-011: The World of Mercy's Anatomy, to July 1, 2005

Revision A. Canon Lock v2.7. The United States, New York City, and the people and places of our story

STATUS: LOCKED IN. *Mercy's Anatomy* takes place in the **real United States**, with its real history, laws, prices, technology and events up to **Friday, July 1, 2005** (S1E1), and moving forward in real time after that. On top of that real world sits **our fictional layer**: the Donohue dynasty, the Victor Donohue Foundation, Queens Grace Hospital, Hudson Mercy, and every character in MA-005. Where the two meet, reality holds, except where this document deliberately says our world differs (§2).

1. The Two Layers

The real world (unchanged)	Our fictional layer (added)
U.S. presidents, Congress, courts, wars, elections and laws	The Donohue-Mercer-Bullock dynasty and its $200B family fortune
Real NYC: mayors, subways, neighborhoods, landmarks, weather	Queens Grace Hospital (1889), One Grace Plaza, LIC
Real news outlets (NYT, Daily News, Post, Newsday, NY1, Queens Chronicle)	The Victor Donohue Foundation ($300B), the Donohue Award, the Mercer Scholars
Real tech timeline (MySpace, RAZR, BlackBerry, YouTube in 2005)	The Donohue Valve (1971), as part of the world's real medical history
Real medicine: ACGME rules, HIPAA, drugs, devices, procedures	Hudson Mercy Medical Center (Jersey City, 1911)
Real pop culture, sports and music	Monty's on Jackson, QueensGraceConfidential, and every character

2. Where Our World Differs from Ours

- **The richest family on earth is the Donohues.** In this world, the Donohue family's $200 billion (2005) makes them the wealthiest family in the world, ahead of every real fortune. Business magazines have tried for years to estimate it and keep getting it low.
- **The largest foundation on earth is the Victor Donohue Foundation.** At $300 billion it is many times larger than any real foundation, and it fills the Harper Avery Foundation's role (C-049).
- **The Donohue Valve is a real medical milestone.** It's in every cardiac surgery textbook in this world. Every surgeon knows the name Donohue, and almost none know what Marc-Anthony

Bullock's grandfather looks like.

- **'The Route 49 Doctor'.** Victor's 1958 loading-dock surgery on Elijah Tate was covered by the Black press at the time, and it's a civil-rights-era legend that Black medical students learn.
- **Queens Grace exists.** It's a real-feeling 1889 safety-net hospital in western Queens, sitting alongside New York's real hospitals, which are never criticized by name.

3. The United States on July 1, 2005

Area	State of the country
Government	President George W. Bush, second term (inaugurated Thursday, January 20, 2005). Vice President Dick Cheney. Republican Congress.
Wars	Iraq (since March 20, 2003) and Afghanistan. Army surgeons rotate through combat hospitals. This is Rod Maddox's world, and later Harmony's.
Firsts	Condoleezza Rice became Secretary of State (January 26, 2005). Barack Obama was sworn in as U.S. Senator from Illinois (January 4, 2005), the only Black senator. In New York, Willie Randolph is in his first season managing the Mets, the first Black manager of a New York baseball team.
Today's news	On Friday, July 1, 2005, Justice Sandra Day O'Connor announces her retirement from the Supreme Court. Live 8 concerts are set for tomorrow, July 2.
Economy	The housing boom is in full swing. Gas is about $2.20 a gallon. The federal minimum wage is $5.15; New York's is $6.00.
Health care	About 46 million Americans are uninsured. Medicare Part D (prescription drugs) starts January 1, 2006. HIPAA has been in force since 2003. Vioxx was withdrawn in September 2004. Fights over malpractice insurance are everywhere.
Medical ethics	Terri Schiavo died on March 31, 2005, after a national end-of-life fight. Stem cell research is divided by federal limits (2001) and California's Proposition 71 (2004). Fears of avian flu are rising.
Black America	Black physicians are a small fraction of U.S. doctors, a gap the Freedmen's Fund and the Mercer Scholars exist to close. The 1997 federal apology for the Tuskegee syphilis study is still fresh in patients' memories, and so is the distrust.
Rights	Same-sex marriage is legal only in Massachusetts (since May 17, 2004). DOMA (1996) is federal law.
Culture	At the movies this summer: *Batman Begins* (June 15), *Star Wars: Episode III* (May 19), *War of the Worlds* (June 29). On TV: *Lost*, *Desperate Housewives*, *American Idol* (Carrie Underwood won in May). On the radio: Mariah Carey's 'We Belong Together' rules the summer.
Tech	Motorola RAZR flip phones; BlackBerrys for attendings; iPods; AIM away messages; MySpace for everyone; Facebook for college students only; YouTube is months old; Google Maps launched in February. No iPhone (2007) and no Twitter (2006).

4. New York City, Summer 2005

- **Leadership:** Mayor Michael Bloomberg is running for re-election (the vote is November 8, 2005). Governor George Pataki. Senators Hillary Clinton and Chuck Schumer. Queens Borough President Helen Marshall.
- **Mood:** four years after 9/11, the city is rebuilding, and the Freedom Tower design is still being fought over. The West Side Stadium plan died on June 6, 2005, and the city's 2012 Olympic bid will lose to London on July 6.

- **Life:** the bar smoking ban has been in effect since 2003 (Monty's on Jackson is smoke-free and the regulars still complain). A MetroCard ride costs $2.00. Summer heat waves and humid nights.
- **Queens:** the most diverse county in America. Long Island City is mid-transformation: factories, 5Pointz, Silvercup Studios and the Pepsi-Cola sign beside new glass towers, with the 2001 rezoning pricing out QGH's own patients.

Mid-2005 New York prices (typical; for scene realism)

Item	Price
Subway or bus ride (MetroCard)	$2.00
Slice of pizza	$2.00-2.50
Bodega coffee, regular	$0.75-1.00
First-class stamp	$0.37
Movie ticket (Manhattan)	~$10.50
Gallon of gas (NYC)	~$2.30
1-bedroom rent, Long Island City	~$1,500-1,800 / month
Motorola RAZR (with contract)	~$199
QGH intern salary (PGY-1)	$44,820 / year

5. Where Our People Live

The House on 49th Avenue (Marc-Anthony Bullock). Marc lives in a **big house** in Hunters Point, ten minutes' walk from Queens Grace: a four-story, seven-bedroom, double-width 1890s brownstone with a back garden and a roof deck that looks straight at the Midtown skyline. To everyone at the hospital it's a **'graduation gift from my parents'** (technically true: Natasha and Robert handed him the keys after his Hopkins graduation in May 2005). In reality it's **one of the hundreds of properties the Donohue family owns**, held through **49th Avenue Holdings LLC** and managed by the Donohue Family Office (Cornelius Fairbanks), so the deed reveals nothing. Harmony and Raven move in as roommates during Season 1. Marc charges them '$400 and groceries' and refuses to take more. It's the counterpart of Meredith's house. Interns ask how a first-year has a place like this, and Marc says, 'My parents really like me.'

Residence Directory. Where every character lives at their debut. Later moves are tracked episode by episode in the Continuity Sheets (MA-009 §6).

Creator's Core Cast

Character	Home (at debut)
Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock	The House on 49th Avenue, Hunters Point, LIC: a big four-story, seven-bedroom 1890s double-width brownstone with a garden and a roof deck facing Manhattan. His story is that it was a 'graduation gift from my parents.' In reality it's one of the Donohue family's hundreds of properties, held through 49th Avenue Holdings LLC.
Dr. Amond Baker	A bare studio in Sunnyside, Queens (43rd Street, off Queens Boulevard)
Dr. Esther Smilley	Aboard her 1978 sailboat Clarence, World's Fair Marina, Flushing Bay, Queens
Dr. Arianna Cummings	A rented room above a Greek bakery on 30th Avenue, Astoria, Queens
Dr. Harmony Divine	Her parents' house in Cambria Heights, Queens; she moves into the House on 49th Avenue in Season 1
Dr. Elxa Bullock	A two-family house in St. Albans, Queens, with her husband Russell
Dr. Grace Bullock	An apartment in Mission Hill, Boston, near Harvard Medical School; she moves to Queens in July 2007
Dr. Natasha Donohue	A Riverside Drive brownstone, Upper West Side, Manhattan
Dr. Robert Bullock	A Riverside Drive brownstone, Upper West Side, Manhattan (with Natasha)
Dr. Victor Donohue	Donohue House, Brookline, Massachusetts
Dr. Joan Mercer	Donohue House, Brookline, Massachusetts
Emma Bullock	With her parents (from Season 7); with Marc whenever Esther is not in the main cast
Marc-Anthony "MJ" Bullock Jr.	With his parents; with Marc whenever Esther is not in the main cast
Victoria Bullock	With Marc (born during Esther's Season 12-18 retraining), and with both parents after

Season 1-3 Era

Character	Home (at debut)
Dr. Raven Ellison	A sublet in Ridgewood, Queens; she moves into the House on 49th Avenue in Season 1
Dr. Clayton Hartwell	A suite at a Midtown Manhattan hotel, then a rented penthouse on the LIC waterfront
Dr. Malcolm Sloan	A penthouse on the Upper East Side, Manhattan; he later lives in a hotel near the hospital
Dr. Camille Toussaint	An apartment in Jackson Heights, Queens
Russell Jeffries	A two-family house in St. Albans, Queens
Russell "Tuck" Jeffries Jr.	With his parents in St. Albans, Queens
Darius "Dash" Duvall	A hospital bed at QGH; his home is in Charlotte, North Carolina
Dr. Faith Danforth	An apartment above her veterinary practice in Astoria, Queens
Lamont "Monty" Gaines	A loft above Monty's on Jackson, LIC
Cedric Hall	A loft above Monty's on Jackson, LIC (with Monty)
Nurse Kendra Wallace	A brownstone apartment in Bedford-Stuyvesant, Brooklyn
Nurse Dexter Coleman	A condo in Jersey City, New Jersey
Bernadette "Bernie" Watkins	A house in Mount Vernon, New York
Nurse Yvette Banks	A house in Jamaica, Queens
Nurse Debra "Deb" Lyons	A house in Ozone Park, Queens
Nurse Roland "Ro" Price	An apartment in Woodside, Queens
Hope Calhoun	With her adoptive parents in Hartford, Connecticut

Season 4-5 Era

Character	Home (at debut)
Dr. Evangeline "Van" Hawthorne	A sleek condo in Tribeca, Manhattan
Dr. Stephon Morrow	A shared apartment in Astoria, Queens
Dr. Danielle "Destruction" Hargrove	Couch-surfing, then a room at the House on 49th Avenue
Dr. Vivian Doss	A quiet apartment in Forest Hills, Queens
Sydnee Reese	With her mother in Boston; later with Malcolm
Dr. Roderick "Rod" Maddox	An extended-stay hotel in LIC, then an apartment in Sunnyside Gardens, Queens
Dr. Autumn Lockett	An apartment in Jackson Heights, Queens; later shared with Camille

Character	Home (at debut)
Dr. Loretta Wise	A co-op in Kew Gardens, Queens

Season 6-10 Era

Character	Home (at debut)
Dr. Teresa "Tess" Langford	An apartment in Hunters Point, LIC
Elliott Barnes	An apartment in Yonkers, New York
Dr. Conrad Ashby	A house in Hoboken, New Jersey
Dr. Eden Whitfield	An apartment in Jersey City, then Long Island City
Dr. Julian Whitmore	A loft in Jersey City, then a waterfront condo in LIC
Dr. Lorraine Whitmore	A townhouse in Boston's South End
Damon Whitmore	Bozeman, Montana
Dr. Kiana Moss	An apartment in Jersey City, New Jersey
Dr. Terrence Pryor	His mother's house in Paterson, New Jersey
Dr. Calvin Holloway	An apartment in Fort Greene, Brooklyn; later with Elxa
Gerald Pickett	A house in Elmhurst, Queens
Dr. Renee Calloway	An apartment in Long Island City
Lt. Melanie Maddox	Missing in Iraq (as believed); later with Rod in Queens
Dr. Lena Bosworth	A hotel during her visiting appointment
Dr. Jordyn Wells	Her car, a 2001 Honda Civic, in a hospital lot (secretly), then an apartment in Astoria
Dr. Phillip Strand	Chicago, Illinois
Dr. Shaunice "Shay" Edmonds	An apartment in Sunnyside, Queens
Dr. Trevor Rhodes	A shared apartment in Woodside, Queens
Dr. Leandra Murray	A shared apartment in Woodside, Queens
Dr. Hannah Brookins	A studio in Astoria, Queens
Sabine Toussaint-Lockett Sloan	With Camille and Autumn, with time at Malcolm's

Season 11-16 Era

Character	Home (at debut)
Dr. Mariah Pettaway	A sublet in Hunters Point, LIC, then a house in Ditmars, Astoria
Dr. Amara Smilley	The House on 49th Avenue (Marc's guest room), then her own apartment in LIC
Dr. Nadia Ridgeway	A rented house in Woodside, Queens

Character	Home (at debut)
Dr. Adrienne Laurent	An apartment in Astoria, Queens
Dr. Celine Laurent	With her brother's old roommates in Astoria, then her own place in Greenpoint, Brooklyn
Dr. Paige Blakely	An apartment in Sunnyside, Queens
Samuel Whitfield-Whitmore	Lived his whole life at Bullock Sloan Memorial
Harriet "Hattie" Whitfield-Whitmore	Split between Eden's and Julian's homes in LIC
Dr. Lionel Bishop	His grandmother's house in Corona, Queens, then an apartment with Nolan
Dr. Tyra Hemphill	An apartment in Ridgewood, Queens
Dr. Samara Bell	Her family's apartment in Flatbush, Brooklyn
Dr. Cassius "Cash" Parks	An apartment in Astoria, Queens
Dr. Vincent Ray	A luxury rental in LIC that he can't afford
Dr. Delilah Quarles	An apartment in Jamaica, Queens
Dr. Tobias Crockett	A penthouse on Central Park West, Manhattan
Dr. Ambrose "Bro" Linwood	A converted garage loft in Greenpoint, Brooklyn; later with Amara
Dr. Nolan Kingsley	An apartment in LIC
Brianna "Bree" Noble	Foster care, then with Rod and Amara
Leo Maddox	With Rod Maddox
Allison Maddox	With Harmony and Rod
Scout Linwood-Smilley	With Amara and Ambrose

Season 17-22 Era

Character	Home (at debut)
Dr. Colette Hargis	A house in Bayside, Queens, with her two sons
Dr. Nicole Marchand	Rochester, Minnesota, then an LIC rental
Dr. Kendall Bartee	An apartment in Long Island City
Dr. Wendell Thornton	A house in Ditmars, Astoria, with Mariah
Dr. Savannah Grier	An apartment in Jamaica, Queens
Dr. Lucien Avant	Aunt Amara's guest room, then a sublet in Astoria
Dr. Jazmine "Jaz" Millner	A co-op house in Ridgewood, Queens
Dr. Mikayla Yates	Her car, then a shared room in Sunnyside
Dr. Bryson "Blue" Quinn	An apartment in LIC

Character	Home (at debut)
Dr. Monét Bellamy	A townhouse in Hunters Point, LIC
Prentiss Holloway	With Elxa and Calvin
Nova Wells	With Jordyn Wells

Families and Loved Ones

Character	Home (at debut)
Dr. Victor "V.J." Donohue Jr.	A Beacon Hill mansion, Boston
Dr. Claudette Donohue	A Beacon Hill mansion, Boston
Dr. Kendrick Donohue	His parents' home in Boston; later an apartment near Mass General
Aria Donohue	Boston, then San Francisco
Victor "Trey" Donohue III	Georgetown University, Washington, D.C.
Dr. Lawrence Donohue	A house in Buckhead, Atlanta, Georgia
Renata Donohue, Esq.	A house in Buckhead, Atlanta, Georgia
Malik and Maya Donohue	Atlanta, Georgia
Dr. Charles "Chip" Donohue	A Beverly Hills estate, California
Bianca Donohue	Beverly Hills, California
Josephine "Grandma Jo" Bullock	Her Shaw rowhouse, Washington, D.C. She refuses to move.
Walter Bullock Sr.	Deceased (1999)
Beverly Bullock-Odom	Brookland, Washington, D.C.
Walter "Junior" Bullock Jr.	Petworth, Washington, D.C.
Corinne Smilley	The family house in Mattapan, Boston
Clarence Smilley	Deceased (1987)
Dr. Naomi Smilley-Crawford	Milton, Massachusetts
Dr. Kathryn "Kat" Smilley	Cambridge, Massachusetts
Elizabeth "Lizzie" Smilley-Ward	Randolph, Massachusetts
Harriet Baker-Fenwick	Baldwin Hills, Los Angeles
Dr. Solomon Fenwick	Baldwin Hills, Los Angeles
Raymond Cummings	Gary, Indiana (no fixed address)
Loretta Cummings	A group home in Merrillville, Indiana
Ahmad and Aaliyah Cummings	Gary, Indiana
Howard Divine	Cambria Heights, Queens
Lillian Divine	Cambria Heights, Queens

Character	Home (at debut)
Jerome "Jerry" and Ronald "Ronnie" Divine	Laurelton and Rosedale, Queens
Dr. Delphine Ware	Deceased (2003); lived in Chicago
Alicia Monroe	Deceased (2001); lived in Hollis, Queens

Original Characters

Character	Home (at debut)
Nurse Gloria Pettiford	A house in Corona, Queens
Raymond "Big Ray" Toles	A house in Laurelton, Queens
Dr. Horace Whitlow	A co-op on the Upper East Side, Manhattan
Dr. Sylvia Rountree	A brownstone on Strivers' Row, Harlem
Dr. Edwin Mabry	A house in Douglaston, Queens
Rev. Dr. Josiah Abernathy	The parsonage of his church in Jamaica, Queens
Celia Montague, LCSW	An apartment in Flushing, Queens
Franklin Bassett, Esq.	A house in Montclair, New Jersey
Hattie "Miss Hattie" Lomax	An apartment in the Queensbridge Houses, LIC
Oliver "Ollie" Freeman	An apartment in the Ravenswood Houses, LIC
Ophelia Grant	Her mother's apartment in Astoria, Queens
Lt. Tanisha "Tee" Rollins	A house in Far Rockaway, Queens
Andre Fontaine	An apartment in Brownsville, Brooklyn
Dana Whitlock	A condo in Hoboken, New Jersey
Curtis "C-Note" Lassiter	A house on City Island, the Bronx
Nadine Ruffin	An apartment in Chelsea, Manhattan
Jerome Tolliver	An apartment in Long Island City
Dorian "Deuce" Mitchell	Shaw, Washington, D.C.
Valencia Burgess	A penthouse in Midtown, Manhattan
Cornelius Fairbanks	Brookline, Massachusetts

6. Real-World Event Calendar for Continuity

Real events the story will meet as it moves forward. Each is honored in the season it falls in (MA-001 §8).

Date	Event	Season	Story relevance
Jul. 7, 2005	London bombings	1	The news in the residents' lounge
Aug. 29, 2005	Hurricane Katrina	1-2	Elxa's 28th birthday; the Toussaint family; the Foundation's $6B pledge
Oct. 24, 2005	Rosa Parks dies	2	Grandma Jo's grief; a hospital moment of silence
Dec. 20-22, 2005	NYC transit strike	2	Staff walk the Queensboro Bridge to work
Sept. 26, 2006	Facebook opens to everyone	3	The secret-identity threat level rises
Jun. 29, 2007	The iPhone launches	3-4	Tech shift; photos everywhere
Sept. 15, 2008	Lehman Brothers collapses	5	The QGH deficit becomes a crisis, leading to the merger
Nov. 4, 2008	Obama elected	5	A night on the Roof
Mar. 23, 2010	Affordable Care Act signed	6	The payer-mix politics of the merger
Jul. 24, 2011	Same-sex marriage legal in New York	8	Camille and Autumn, and every couple who waited
Oct. 29, 2012	Hurricane Sandy floods Long Island City	9	A storm and evacuation episode at the renamed hospital
Apr. 15, 2013	Boston Marathon bombing	9	The Donohue family's home city
Jun. 26, 2015	Obergefell v. Hodges	11	Marriage equality nationwide
Mar. 2020 onward	COVID-19 pandemic (NYC as the epicenter)	16-17	The counterpart's pandemic season
May 25, 2020	George Floyd murdered	16-17	A reckoning across the all-Black cast's world
Jun. 24, 2022	Dobbs decision	18-19	Esther, Grace and OB/GYN on the front line

7. How the World Talks (2005 Slang and Usage)

- **Everyday:** 'my bad,' 'for real,' 'that's crazy,' 'I'm dead' (meaning hilarious), 'off the chain,' 'holla at me,' 'it's whatever,' 'crunk,' 'bling' (already a little dated), 'fo' shizzle' (strictly ironic).
- **Hospital:** 'scut,' 'pimping' (attendings quizzing interns), 'GOMER,' 'circling the drain,' 'the Pit,' 'Gracelings,' 'the Board,' 'call room,' 'bounce-back,' 'turf' (to push a patient to another service).
- **Never in 2005:** 'tweet,' 'selfie,' 'app' (as a phone word), 'FaceTime,' 'stan,' 'no cap,' 'slay' (in its modern sense), 'lowkey' (in its modern sense). Slang moves forward with the calendar.

8. On Air: The Morning of S1E1

NY1 MORNING HEADLINES, Friday, July 1, 2005, 5:00 AM (in-world)

- Supreme Court Justice Sandra Day O'Connor expected to address her future today.
- Heat advisory for the five boroughs this weekend; Fourth of July fireworks set for the East River.
- New York's 2012 Olympic bid enters its final week before the IOC vote.
- **LONG ISLAND CITY:** Queens Grace Hospital welcomes a new class of surgical interns this morning with its rooftop 'Dawn Oath,' a tradition dating to 1968.
- **BOSTON:** the Victor Donohue Foundation closes its fiscal year with a record $18.9 billion in charitable spending.

O'Connor's announcement came later that morning. The anchor's 'expected' line keeps it timing-accurate at 5:00 AM.

9. Canon Log Additions

ID	Established fact	Source
C-063	The story world is the real United States, with real history to July 1, 2005, plus our fictional layer. Reality holds except where MA-011 §2 says otherwise.	MA-011
C-064	In this world, the Donohues are the richest family on earth and the Foundation is the largest foundation. The Donohue Valve is real medical history.	MA-011 §2
C-065	Marc lives in a big house, the House on 49th Avenue in Hunters Point. It's presented as a 'graduation gift from my parents' but is really one of the Donohue family's many properties (49th Avenue Holdings LLC). Harmony and Raven move in during Season 1.	MA-011 §5
C-068	Every character's home at debut is listed in the MA-011 §5 Residence Directory and on their MA-005 card.	MA-011 §5
C-066	Esther lives aboard the sailboat Clarence at the World's Fair Marina, Flushing Bay.	MA-011 §5
C-067	The real-world event calendar (MA-011 §6) is binding for continuity.	MA-011 §6

END OF MA-011. CANON LOCKED (v2.7, REV. A). The world is set. It's 5:30 AM on July 1, 2005, and the interns are climbing to the Roof.